

Listening

We will watch an important lecture below on the topic of feminism from 2012 which was mentioned in the topic input article.



We should all be feminists | Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie | TEDxEuston

https://www.ted.com/talks/chimamanda_ngozi_adichie_we_should_all_be_feminists

Task 1: Before we watch it, read and discuss the following 3 excerpts, using the following points to guide you.

- 1) What is the speaker's message/key point?
- 2) Is something that you can relate to, or something that you have not noticed?
- 3) Do you have any personal examples?
- 4) What personal conclusions you can infer from it: what do you think?

Excerpt 1:

I often make the mistake of thinking that something that is obvious to me is just as obvious to everyone else. Now, take my dear friend Louis for example. Louis is a brilliant, progressive man, and we would have conversations and he would tell me, "I don't know what you mean by things being different or harder for women. Maybe in the past, but not now." And I didn't understand how Louis could not see what seems so self-evident. (04:46 on the video)

Excerpt 2:

...[I]f we start raising children differently, then in fifty years, in a hundred years, boys will no longer have the pressure of having to prove this masculinity. But by far the worst thing we do to males, by making them feel that they have to be hard, is that we leave them with very fragile egos. The more "hard man" the man feels compelled to be, the weaker his ego is. And then we do a much greater disservice to girls because we raise them to cater to the fragile egos of men. We teach girls to shrink themselves, to make themselves smaller...(11:29 on the video)

Excerpt 3:

Now imagine how much happier we would be, how much freer to be our true individual selves, if we didn't have the weight of gender expectations. Boys and girls are undeniably different biologically, but socialization exaggerates the differences and then it becomes a self-fulfilling process. (18:41 on the video)

Task 2: The lecture is fairly long, so you can only watch it once. As you listen, you should take notes – have a look at the questions below in detail first.

1. Note some examples the speaker gives of the perception of 'feminists' she faced.
2. Adichie (2012) gives several examples throughout the talk of how she has received different treatment from men. Note some of them down.
3. What is her point regarding historical male domination and modern-day **leadership**?
4. What does Adichie (2012) suggest is the way to create "a different world, a fairer world, a world of happier men and happier women"?
5. How do boys grow up being taught to behave?
6. How do girls grow up being taught to behave?
7. What is her point about culture?
8. How does Adichie (2012) define 'feminism' herself?

Task 3: Listen to the lecture and take notes. This is challenging, but it's a skill that requires practise and is important at LSE when attending lectures.

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Task 4: In pairs/small groups, try and answer the questions before looking together as a class.

Task 5: Adichie's talk focuses largely on Nigeria, and thus likely to include many differences from your lived experience. However, do you recognise anything she says as true of your experience, or in your country (now or in the past)?

Vocabulary

My brother is very good at giving me **unsolicited** advice.

“Women are feminists because they can’t find husbands.” I’m saying this **tongue-in-cheek**.

The **realisation** dawned on me that

It dawned on me that my teacher was serious when she said that girls cannot be class monitor.

If women are the **breadwinners**, men may feel emasculated.